Lockout / Tagout Procedure for Machines and Robot Cells

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Classification	Internal		

1 Purpose

Lockout/tagout (LOTO) protects people from the unexpected start-up of machines and the release of stored energy during maintenance, repair, cleaning and set-up.

2 Who may perform LOTO

Only persons who have completed the LOTO training (refresher every 12 months) may lock out a machine. Every person working inside the danger zone applies their own personal padlock. Padlocks are red, personal and have only one key.

3 The six steps

1. Prepare: identify all energy sources using the energy isolation sheet at the machine (electrical, pneumatic, hydraulic, gravity, springs).
2. Inform: tell the operator and the shift leader that the machine will be shut down.
3. Shut down the machine with the normal stop.
4. Isolate all energy sources: main switch off, compressed air valve closed and vented, hydraulic pressure released.
5. Lock and tag: apply your personal padlock and a tag with name, date and phone number to every isolation point.
6. Verify zero energy: try to start the machine with the start button, check that the pressure gauges show 0 bar and measure absence of voltage where the energy isolation sheet requires it.

4 Removing the lock

Each person removes only their own lock. Before removal, check that all tools are removed, guards are refitted and nobody is in the danger zone. If a person has left the site and forgot to remove the lock, only the maintenance manager may remove it after trying to contact the person and checking the machine.

5 Group lockout

For work with more than 3 persons, a group lock box is used. The responsible person locks the isolation points and puts the keys into the box. Every team member applies their personal padlock to the box.

6 Revision history

Rev	Date	Change
B	2024-06-12	Group lockout added
C	2025-09-01	Refresher interval 24 -> 12 months